BIRDWING AIRLINES

Customer Experience Operations Manual

Standard operating procedures for agents, team leads and managers

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1. Purpose, Scope and Principles

1.1 This manual is the standard operating procedure (SOP) for Birdwing's Customer Experience (CX) function. It tells agents, senior agents, team leads, managers and quality analysts how to handle contacts about reservations, changes, refunds, disruptions, baggage, loyalty, complaints and regulatory escalations.

1.2 It applies to all employees and outsourced partner agents working on Birdwing queues in Gurugram, Bengaluru, Pune and the Manila overflow centre, and to airport customer service duty managers when they use CX systems.

1.3 Where this manual is stricter than the public Conditions of Carriage (BW-PUB-001), agents follow this manual. Where it is silent, agents follow the Conditions of Carriage, then escalate to a Team Lead. Agents may never promise anything that is not in one of these two documents or the CX Knowledge Base.

1.4 **Service principles.** (a) Own the problem until it is solved or handed over with a warm transfer. (b) Be accurate before being fast. (c) Never argue, never blame other departments. (d) Treat the passenger's time as valuable. (e) Protect customer data as if it were our own.

2. Organisation and Contact Channels

Role	Responsibility	Typical span
Agent (L1)	Handles calls, chats, email and social queries within authority limits	1 Team Lead per 14 agents
Senior Agent (L2)	Complex bookings, refunds above L1 limit, mentoring, escalations from L1	1 per 10 agents
Team Lead	Floor management, approvals, coaching, escalation point	14 agents
Duty Manager	Shift-level control, disruption response, VIP and media cases	1 per shift per site
CX Manager	Site performance, quality, budgets and regulatory responses	Per site
Nodal Officer	Handles regulator-mandated grievance stage 2, reports to Head of CX	Corporate
Head of Customer Experience	Policy owner, final authority on disputed cases and ex-gratia	Corporate

2.1 Queues and Skills

Queue	Channel	Languages	Hours (IST)
General Reservations	Phone 1800-123-4567	English, Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Marathi, Bengali	06:00 to 23:00
Disruption Desk	Phone, chat	English, Hindi	24 x 7
Accessibility and Medical	Phone 1800-123-4570, email	English, Hindi	08:00 to 20:00
Birdwing Miles	Phone 1800-123-4580, chat	English, Hindi	08:00 to 22:00
Baggage Tracing	Email, phone	English, Hindi	08:00 to 22:00
Social Media	X, Instagram, Facebook	English, Hindi	08:00 to 22:00
Corporate and Groups	Email, dedicated number	English	09:00 to 19:00 weekdays
Executive Escalations	Internal transfer only	English	09:00 to 21:00

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3. Customer Identity Verification and Data Protection

3.1 Verification Levels

Level	When required	Items to verify
Level 1 (basic)	General fare, schedule and baggage information; no booking details disclosed	None
Level 2 (standard)	Viewing or changing a booking, adding services, seat or meal	PNR plus one of: lead passenger name as on ticket, registered email, registered mobile number
Level 3 (enhanced)	Cancellation with refund, refund status above INR 10,000, name correction, contact detail changes, Birdwing Miles redemptions, any third-party request	PNR plus lead passenger name plus any two of: last 4 digits of payment card, date of birth, registered email, registered mobile number, and a one-time password (OTP) sent to the registered mobile

- Never read out a full card number, passport number, complete email address or full phone number. Mask all but the last 4 characters.
- A third party (travel agent, relative, assistant) may act only with a written authorisation from the passenger, uploaded to the case. Corporate travel managers are verified through the corporate account code.
- After **3 failed verification attempts** in one contact, stop, apply the Verification Lock tag, and transfer to the Fraud and Verification Desk. Do not tell the customer which answers were wrong.
- Deceased passenger bookings: do not disclose details to callers. Transfer to Team Lead; documentation includes a death certificate and proof of relationship.
- Pause call recording when taking card details, and resume only after the payment has been processed. Never write card details on paper or in notes.

3.2 Data Protection Rules

- Birdwing complies with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, and the GDPR for EU and UK customers.
- Customer data may only be accessed on approved CX workstations. Mobile phones are not allowed on the contact centre floor except in the designated lockers area.
- Screens must be locked every time the agent leaves their desk. A clean desk is required; no pens and paper on the production floor unless issued by the Team Lead.
- Call recordings are retained for **180 days**; chat and email transcripts are retained for **3 years**.
- Suspected data exposure (wrong email sent, wrong person given details) must be reported to IT Security and the Duty Manager **immediately** and not later than **4 hours** after discovery, using the Data Incident form. The Data Protection Officer decides whether a regulatory notification is needed.
- Customer requests to access, correct or erase data are logged under category DPR-01 and sent to privacy@birdwingair.com. Agents do not action them directly.

4. Service Level Targets and Performance Metrics

Metric	Target	Measured
Phone service level	80% of calls answered in 30 seconds	Half-hourly
Abandon rate (phone)	Under 5%	Daily
Chat first response	Within 60 seconds	Per chat

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Metric	Target	Measured
Email first response	Within 4 working hours internally; customer promise 2 working days	Per email
Social media first response	Within 60 minutes (08:00 to 22:00)	Per mention
Average handling time (AHT)	Phone 6 minutes; chat 9 minutes (concurrency 2); email 7 minutes	Weekly
First contact resolution (FCR)	80% or better	Weekly
Customer satisfaction (CSAT)	88% or better	Monthly
Net Promoter Score (NPS), CX contacts	+45	Monthly
Quality score	85% or better (see section 14)	Monthly
Schedule adherence	92% or better	Daily
Written complaint acknowledgement	Within 48 hours	Per case
Written complaint resolution	Final reply in 15 working days	Per case

5. Reservation Changes, Cancellations and Refunds

5.1 Authority Limits for Refunds, Waivers and Goodwill

Approver	Refund, waiver or goodwill per case (INR)	Daily team cap
Agent (L1)	Up to 5,000	n/a
Senior Agent (L2)	Up to 25,000	n/a
Team Lead	Up to 75,000	INR 5,00,000 per team
Duty Manager	Up to 1,50,000	INR 15,00,000 per shift
CX Manager	Up to 3,00,000	INR 40,00,000 per month per site
Head of Customer Experience	Above 3,00,000 (up to INR 10,00,000)	n/a
Chief Commercial Officer	Above INR 10,00,000	n/a

Goodwill means anything given beyond the passenger's entitlement under the Conditions of Carriage or regulations, including vouchers, fee waivers and miles. The monetary value of a goodwill gesture is recorded in the CRM at its cash value.

5.2 Fee Waiver Decision Table

Situation	Waiver allowed?	Approver
Change or cancellation within the 48-hour look-in window, booked 7 or more days before departure	Yes, all fees (not the fare difference)	Agent
Passenger or immediate family member has a medical emergency (certificate within 7 days)	Yes, cancellation fee waived; refund in cash	Agent up to INR 5,000; else per matrix
Bereavement (death certificate)	Yes, cancellation fee waived; refund in cash	Agent up to INR 5,000; else per matrix
Airline-initiated schedule change over 2 hours	Yes, all fees; free change or full refund	Agent

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Situation	Waiver allowed?	Approver
Duplicate booking (same names, same flight, within 24 hours)	Yes, one booking fully refunded if payment confirmed twice	Senior Agent
Passenger error (wrong date, wrong name) outside look-in	No, apply fare rules; consider one-time waiver of 50% of change fee for Gold and Platinum	Team Lead
Missed flight (no-show) due to traffic or airport delays	No; refund taxes and charges only; Flex and Business per fare rule	n/a
Visa rejected or denied entry by immigration	Taxes only on non-refundable fares; full fare refund only with Duty Manager approval and evidence	Duty Manager
Natural disaster or airport closure at passenger's location	Yes, fee waived, with evidence or official notice	Team Lead

5.3 Refund Procedure

- Verify at Level 3. Confirm the payment method and who paid.
- Check the fare rule in the reservation system (RES) and calculate the refund: fare paid minus cancellation fee, plus taxes and charges.
- Always refund to the **original form of payment**. Never refund to a different card, bank account or person. If the card is closed, raise a Payment Exception ticket for Finance (reference REF-PX).
- Record the reason code from Appendix A, the amount, the approver and the PNR in the CRM before closing the case.
- Give the customer the refund reference number and the timeline: **7 working days** for card and UPI, immediately for counter cash. For refunds through travel agents, 7 working days from Birdwing to the agent.
- Voucher option: if the customer asks, offer a Birdwing voucher valid for 12 months with a **10% bonus**. Do not offer the voucher first. Never pressure a customer to take a voucher in place of a refund they are entitled to.

5.4 Chargebacks and Disputes

- If the customer says they will dispute with their bank, state the refund status and timeline. Do not threaten or discourage a chargeback.
- Open a Chargeback Pre-Alert case so that Revenue Assurance can respond to the bank within the 10-day window.
- Suspected fraudulent transactions are transferred to the Fraud and Verification Desk immediately, without further discussion of the booking.

6. Disruption Handling: Delays, Cancellations and Denied Boarding

6.1 Roles During Disruptions

- The Operations Control Centre (OCC) declares a disruption and issues an Event Code. The CX Duty Manager activates the Disruption Desk and sets the Disruption Playbook level.
- **Level 1:** up to 10 flights affected in a day. Normal queues. **Level 2:** 11 to 50 flights. Disruption Desk expanded, scripted FAQ in use. **Level 3:** over 50 flights or a hub closure. Command Team activated; only the approved script and FAQ may be used; leave is cancelled for CX staff.

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6.2 Passenger Entitlements Agents May Offer

Situation	Entitlement (minimum under DGCA CAR Section 3, Series M, Part IV)	Birdwing service standard
Delay of 2 to 4 hours (flight block time under 2.5 hours: from 2 hours)	Meals and refreshments	Meal voucher INR 300 for delays over 2 hours; INR 450 if over 4 hours
Delay over 6 hours, passenger informed less than 24 hours before departure	Alternate flight or full refund	Goodwill voucher INR 1,500 if Birdwing-caused
Delay over 24 hours (or over 6 hours for departures between 20:00 and 03:00)	Hotel and transfers plus meals	Hotel at partner properties; transfers by pre-approved cab; INR 600 meal allowance
Cancellation with at least 2 weeks notice	Alternate flight or full refund	Same
Cancellation with notice of 2 weeks to 24 hours	Alternate flight within 2 hours of the original, or full refund	Same
Cancellation with less than 24 hours notice, no alternate offered	Refund plus compensation: INR 5,000, 7,500 or 10,000 by block time (or basic fare plus fuel charge if lower)	Goodwill voucher INR 2,000 if the passenger accepts an alternate flight
Denied boarding, alternate within 1 hour	None	Meal voucher INR 300
Denied boarding, alternate within 24 hours	200% of basic fare plus fuel charge, maximum INR 10,000	Same; paid at the airport
Denied boarding, alternate after 24 hours or declined	400% of basic fare plus fuel charge, maximum INR 20,000, plus refund if declined	Same; paid at the airport

- Weather, ATC restrictions, airport closure, strike and security events are force majeure. Offer rebooking or full refund, meals if applicable, but do **not** offer goodwill vouchers without Team Lead approval.
- Downgrade compensation: 30%, 50% or 75% of the fare by distance (see BW-PUB-001 clause 14.5). Process through category DWN-01; Team Lead approval needed.
- Rebooking priority: (1) medical, stretcher and PRM passengers, (2) unaccompanied minors, (3) Platinum, then Gold, (4) families with infants, (5) Business, (6) all others by booking time.
- Always rebook on Birdwing first. Rebooking on another carrier needs Duty Manager approval and is limited to when no Birdwing seat is available within 6 hours.

6.3 Communication Standard During Disruptions

- Proactive SMS and email are sent by the Disruption Desk within 15 minutes of a status change. Agents should not duplicate these contacts.
- Use the phrase: "We are sorry for the disruption to your journey. Here is what we can do right now." Do not blame airports, ATC or weather directly unless the OCC statement says so.
- Never speculate on the cause or the expected restoration time. Use the latest timeline given in the Event Code note.
- At Level 3, the Command Team publishes updates every 30 minutes on the CX intranet. If nothing new, state: "No change since the last update at HH:MM."

7. Baggage Claims and Property Irregularities

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- Create a Property Irregularity Report (PIR) in WorldTracer for every delayed, damaged, pilfered or missing bag. Give the customer the PIR reference (airport code, airline code, 5 digits).
- **Delayed bags:** arrange delivery to the customer's address at no cost. Reimburse essential items (toiletries, basic clothing) up to **INR 2,500 per day** for a maximum of **3 days** against receipts, if the bag is delayed more than 6 hours on arrival at the passenger's home city or 12 hours otherwise.
- **Lost bags:** a bag not found within **21 days** is declared lost. Domestic compensation is INR 350 per kg of checked weight, up to INR 20,000, or the declared value if the passenger declared a higher value and paid the fee. International claims follow the Montreal Convention limits and are calculated by the Claims Desk.
- **Damaged bags:** offer repair at an approved vendor first. If beyond repair, reimburse depreciated value (depreciation of 10% per year of age, minimum residual 30%) up to INR 15,000 with photos and the bag tag.
- **Pilferage:** notify the airport station manager and Security. Claims are paid only for items listed on the PIR within 24 hours of arrival and supported by receipts.
- **Not covered:** fragile items, perishables, cash, jewellery, electronics, documents, medicines and business samples when carried in checked baggage; normal wear and tear; and items not reported within the claim windows (7 days for damage, 21 days for delay).
- Escalate claims above INR 20,000 or involving a possible theft to the Claims Desk (claims@birdwingair.com). Target for settlement: **15 working days** from receipt of documents.
- Update the customer every **48 hours** by SMS until the bag is found or the claim is declared lost.

8. Special Handling: Medical, Accessibility, Minors and Pets

8.1 Medical Clearance

- Customers with serious illness, recent surgery, a cast, or who need oxygen or stretcher must submit a MEDIF form signed by their doctor. The Medical Desk (medical@birdwingair.com) reviews within **24 hours** and decides within **48 hours**.
- Do not give medical advice. Do not say that the airline considers a condition unfit; refer the case to the Medical Desk.
- Stretcher requests need 5 working days notice, occupy 9 seats on A320 family aircraft, and are charged at 9 fares. Stretcher carriage is not possible on ATR 72.

8.2 Wheelchair and Accessibility

- Add the SSR code (WCHR, WCHS, WCHC) at booking or at least 48 hours before departure. Confirm that the airport has been notified (message status OK in RES).
- Passengers who book wheelchair services less than 48 hours before departure can be supported on a best effort basis; do not refuse the request.
- Customers cannot be asked for medical proof for wheelchair assistance when they can still walk to the aircraft.

8.3 Unaccompanied Minors (UM)

- UM service is mandatory for ages 5 to 11 on non-stop flights only. Fee: INR 3,500 domestic, INR 6,000 international per sector.
- Send the UM form to the origin and destination stations at least **48 hours** before departure. The pickup person must carry original government photo ID and the UM authority letter.
- If the receiving person does not appear within 30 minutes of arrival, the airport Duty Manager contacts the guardian and, if unreachable, the local child protection authority.

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8.4 Pets and Service Animals

- Pets in cabin: up to 7 kg including carrier, maximum 2 per flight, INR 4,500 per sector. Pets in hold: up to 32 kg including kennel, INR 6,500 per sector, subject to the temperature embargo (above 32 degrees Celsius at any station) and not allowed on ATR 72 flights.
- Service animals are free but need 48 hours notice and training and vaccination certificates.
- Agents may not promise space for pets without checking the live availability in RES.

9. Complaints and Escalations

9.1 Severity Levels

Level	Examples	Owner	Response target
1 Low	Seat issue, minor service lapse, general feedback	Agent	Same day
2 Medium	Refund dispute, repeated delay, baggage claim dispute	Team Lead	2 working days
3 High	Injury, discrimination allegation, social media escalation with over 10,000 views, VIP or media enquiry	Duty Manager and CX Manager	4 working hours
4 Critical	Safety incident, legal notice, regulator or court complaint, death of a passenger, hate speech	Head of CX, Legal and Communications	Immediate (within 1 hour)

9.2 Handling Method (LEAP)

- **Listen** without interrupting for the first 60 seconds.
- **Empathise** with the customer's feeling, not the airline's position.
- **Apologise** for the experience: "I am sorry that this happened". Do not admit legal liability or blame individuals.
- **Provide** a solution with an owner and a date. If unable to solve, say what you will do next and when.

9.3 When to Escalate

- Transfer the call to a Team Lead if the customer asks for a supervisor twice, if the call exceeds **20 minutes** without a resolution, or if the customer is abusive after one warning.
- Any message mentioning a lawyer, legal notice, consumer court, DGCA, AirSewa, Ministry of Civil Aviation, CPGRAMS, or a Member of Parliament is **Level 4**. Do not discuss liability. Log the details, and notify Legal and the Head of CX within **1 hour**.
- Allegations of discrimination, harassment or misconduct by a Birdwing employee must be sent to the confidential ethics channel (speakup@birdwingair.com). Customer Experience does not investigate them.
- Safety concerns reported by a passenger about an aircraft, maintenance or crew are transferred to the Safety Desk immediately (ext. 4400). Do not give opinions or assurances.

9.4 Regulatory Grievance Redressal (Nodal Officer Process)

Stage	Owner	Timeline
Customer Care response	Agent or Team Lead	Acknowledge in 48 hours, reply in 15 working days
Nodal Officer review	Nodal Officer	Reply in 7 working days of customer's escalation

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Stage	Owner	Timeline
Appellate Authority	Appellate Authority (Head of Customer Experience delegate)	Final response in 15 working days
AirSewa and DGCA complaints	Regulatory Affairs with CX	Respond to the regulator within the date it gives (normally 7 days)

- Every AirSewa or DGCA complaint is reviewed by the Head of CX before closure. Responses must be factual, with PNR timeline, regulation cited and action taken.
- Keep all case notes factual. Notes can be disclosed to a regulator or a court.

10. Birdwing Miles Loyalty Support

- Missing miles requests: accepted within **90 days** of travel with boarding pass or e-ticket receipt. Agents can credit up to 5,000 miles without approval.
- Expired miles: agents may restore expired miles once per member if they expired within the last **30 days**. Team Lead approval for older.
- Tier status extensions of up to **3 months** as goodwill need Team Lead approval; up to 6 months need CX Manager.
- Miles transfers between members: not allowed except via Family Pool. Do not process requests that appear to sell miles; report them to the Loyalty Fraud team.
- Never disclose another member's mileage balance, address, or itinerary history, including to relatives.
- Account lockouts are resolved by the Loyalty team; agents do not reset passwords. Direct customers to the reset link.

11. Social Media Customer Care

- Respond to public posts within 60 minutes (08:00 to 22:00) with an empathetic public reply, then move to a private direct message. Never ask for a PNR, phone number or email in a public reply.
- Do not argue publicly. Do not delete negative comments. Report abusive or threatening posts to the Social Media Lead.
- Posts from verified accounts, journalists, public officials or posts with over 10,000 views are **Level 3**. Notify the Duty Manager and Corporate Communications before replying.
- Use only approved templates (Appendix B) and keep to under 280 characters on X.

12. Fraud, Safety and Security Situations

- **Suspected payment fraud:** do not confirm or deny booking details. Place a Fraud Hold tag and notify the Fraud and Verification Desk.
- **Phishing and fake websites:** if a customer reports a fake Birdwing site or caller, record the URL or number, advise the customer not to share OTP, and forward to cybersecurity@birdwingair.com.
- **Bomb threat or hoax:** if a threat is received on any channel, do not hang up or delete the message. Notify the Duty Manager and the Security Control Room (ext. 4411) immediately. Record the exact words, time, number and any background noise.
- **Self-harm or emergency:** if a customer expresses an intent to harm themselves or others, stay on the line, collect their location, and alert the Duty Manager, who will contact emergency services.

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- **Abusive customers:** give one verbal warning: "I want to help you, but I cannot continue if the language continues." If it continues, end the call and log the contact as Abuse (code ABS-01).

13. Tools, Notes and Case Management

System	Purpose
RES	Reservation system: PNRs, fares, seats, SSRs, refunds
CX Cloud (CRM)	Cases, notes, templates, macros, quality forms
WorldTracer	Baggage tracing and PIR management
Telephony (CX Voice)	Calls, queues, recordings and real-time dashboards
Knowledge Base	Policy, fare rules, disruption FAQ, scripts
Payments Console	Refund status and payment exceptions (view only for L1)
Loyalty System	Birdwing Miles accounts, miles adjustments, tier status

- Every contact is recorded in the CRM with the PNR, a reason code (Appendix A), actions taken and any promises made.
- Use the standard note format: **Who / What / Action / Next step / Deadline**.
- Use macros for common replies but personalise the first and last lines. Never paste text without reading it first.
- Cases with a promised callback must have a callback task created with the time given to the customer.
- Cases can be closed only when the issue is resolved, the customer confirms, or three contact attempts have been made over 3 days.

14. Quality Assurance and Coaching

14.1 Quality Scorecard

Category	Weight	What is assessed
Opening and verification	15%	Greeting, correct verification level, recording statement
Understanding and accuracy	25%	Probing, correct policy and fare rules, correct reason code
Resolution and ownership	25%	Right solution, follow-up commitments, no avoidable transfers
Communication and empathy	20%	Tone, clarity, empathy, LEAP use
Documentation and compliance	15%	Notes, data protection, authority limits respected

- Each agent has **5** calls and **3** chat or email contacts audited per week by a Quality Analyst. Auto-fail items: sharing data without verification, wrong refund method, misinformation about a regulatory entitlement, and abusive language.
- Agents below **75%** for two consecutive months enter a 30-day performance plan with weekly coaching; below 65% for three months can lead to disciplinary action per the People Policy Handbook.
- Team Leads hold a 30-minute one-to-one with each agent weekly. Monthly calibration sessions align Quality Analysts and Team Leads.
- Top performers by CSAT and quality are recognised monthly through the Wing Star programme.

15. Workforce Management and Training

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- Shifts are 9 hours including a 60-minute unpaid break and two paid 15-minute breaks. Weekly offs are 2 days, rotated.
- Peak periods (Dec 20 to Jan 8, May 15 to Jun 10, Diwali week) require team leads to freeze planned leave for at least 70% of agents.
- New hire training: 4 weeks classroom (aviation basics, RES, fare rules, CRM, soft skills), 2 weeks nesting with a mentor, then certification. Pass mark is 80%.
- Annual refresher: refunds and regulations (4 hours), data protection (2 hours), disruption playbook (2 hours), accessibility awareness (2 hours).
- No agent may handle disruption queues before completing the Disruption Desk certification.

Appendix A. Reason Codes

Code	Description
RFD-01	Refund: voluntary cancellation
RFD-02	Refund: Birdwing cancellation or schedule change
RFD-03	Refund: medical or bereavement waiver
RFD-04	Refund: duplicate booking
RFD-05	Refund: look-in cancellation
CHG-01	Date or time change
CHG-02	Name correction
DIS-01	Delay: meals and refreshments
DIS-02	Cancellation: rebooking or refund
DIS-03	Denied boarding compensation
DWN-01	Cabin downgrade compensation
BAG-01	Delayed baggage
BAG-02	Damaged baggage
BAG-03	Lost baggage
BAG-04	Pilferage
LOY-01	Missing miles
LOY-02	Miles expiry restoration
SSR-01	Wheelchair or medical request
CMP-01	Complaint: service
CMP-02	Complaint: regulatory (AirSewa, DGCA)
DPR-01	Data privacy request
ABS-01	Abusive customer

Appendix B. Approved Phrases and Templates

Opening

"Thank you for calling Birdwing, this is (name). This call is recorded for quality and training. How may I help you today?"

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Empathy statements

- "I understand how frustrating this must be. Let me see what I can do right away."
- "I am sorry that your bag did not arrive with you. I will start the tracing now and arrange delivery."
- "I can see why this is upsetting, and I want to make sure we put it right."

Refund timeline

"Your refund of INR (amount) has been approved to your original payment method. Your reference is (number). You can expect it within 7 working days. You will also receive an SMS confirmation."

When unable to help

"I am not able to approve that myself, but I can ask my Team Lead to review it. May I put you on a brief hold, or would you like a callback within 2 hours?"

Closing

"Is there anything else I can help you with today? Thank you for flying with Birdwing."

Phrases to avoid

- "That is not our fault."
- "It is the policy." (Explain what the policy is and why.)
- "You should have..."
- "I cannot do anything." (Offer an alternative.)

Appendix C. Glossary

Term	Meaning
AHT	Average Handling Time
FCR	First Contact Resolution
CSAT	Customer Satisfaction score
OCC	Operations Control Centre
PIR	Property Irregularity Report
SSR	Special Service Request
MEDIF	Medical Information Form
UM	Unaccompanied Minor
Force majeure	Events beyond the airline's control
Ex-gratia	A payment made voluntarily without admitting legal liability

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